Sri Lanka Institute of Information Technology

Assignment 1

Employability Readiness – Evidence-Based Reflection

Employability Skills Development (ESD) – IT3050

B.Sc. (Hons) in Information Technology

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1. Evidence-Based Self-Reflection & Lecture Impact Analysis

1.1 Real Incident and Reflection

While working at the Bank of Ceylon Head Office Data Center, I faced the critical experience that greatly shaped my professional self. I thought that my job was to work either in Quality Assurance or Business Analysis departments; however, I ended up doing tasks in a server room, which was something new and unknown to me. Although I was thrown into a completely different environment, I successfully coped with it because of my flexibility and the ability to work professionally and independently.

As a result of working at the Bank, I developed my ability to work independently while handling complex technical systems professionally, which was a valuable skill for me to master. In addition, my supervisor helped me to adapt to the situation, thus enabling me to gain the knowledge necessary for effective work there. Consequently, I identified my strengths – responsibility and adaptability – and found what needs to be worked on in order to improve further – mainly my ability to communicate and solve problems independently.

The outcome of this activity was quite positive, since I managed to adapt to a completely unexpected task. At the same time, I realized that professionalism is associated with willingness to go beyond one's comfort zone and learn new things continuously.

1.2 Self- Evaluation with Evidence and Risks

Accountability (4/5):
I was very diligent about following all rules and procedures.
Risk: Too frequent double checking of all assignments.

Communication (3/5):
I asked clarifying questions.
Risk: Lack of confidence when communicating professionally.

Teamwork (3/5):
I worked together with colleagues.
Risk: The need for developing independent problem-solving skills.

Adaptability (5/5):
I easily adapted to an unexpected change of my work environment.
Risk: Over-adaptation without enough confidence.

Professional Discipline (4/5):
I strictly observed all procedures and guidelines.
Risk: Need to improve planning skills and time management.

1.3 Lecture Impact Analysis

One of the lectures made a great impression on me. It was devoted to the topics of leadership and personal responsibility. It emphasized the difference between passengers and drivers. After this, I understood that in order to have success, I need to become a driver myself. That is, trust my skills, be confident and improve constantly.

2. Industry Alignment & Professional Judgment

One of the industries that interest me is Information Technology where a Junior Data Center Operations Associate is needed at a bank.

The skills that are expected for this position are:

- Attention to Detail: It includes diligent system monitoring in order to prevent any problems or issues.
- Security Protocols Adherence: It includes compliance with the rules which help preserve data integrity and the operation of the system.
- Effective Communication: It implies prompt reporting of any problem and constant informing of supervisors.

As regards the skills I possess at present, the following are the skills:

- I pay attention to details since I know very well that one wrong move can harm the company.
- To me, adhering to security protocols is a responsibility that I have to fulfill. I am new here and eager to learn.
- I try to be more proactive so that in case I need to talk to my supervisor, I will do that without hesitation.

If I notice a minor warning in a system and if someone tells me to disregard it, I will not follow this advice. It is possible that this minor issue will cause some problems if left unattended. If a system breaks down in a bank, it may harm customers who may lose confidence and money because of it. That is why I prefer to report on it and avoid risks for the Bank of Ceylon.

3. My Immediate Upgrade Plan

In order to align myself with industry norms and standards in terms of skills and experience, I have prepared an action plan for myself which covers three goals to help me progress in my career at the Bank of Ceylon within the next six months.

Goals and Actions:

1. Expand knowledge regarding the system at the Bank of Ceylon:

- Earn networking and server certification.
- Know how the systems operate so that I can actively participate in discussions.

2. Develop practical and applicable skills:
    - Simulate actual scenarios by using labs.
    - Work on projects to gain practical exposure.
    - Increase self-confidence and prepare for future careers.
3. Develop effective communication skills:
    - Join discussion forums.
    - Make formal presentations.
    - Communicate technical information in an effective and confident manner.

Self-reflection:

- My experience at the Bank of Ceylon has taught me persistence and accountability.
- Confidence and assertiveness need to be improved upon.
- I have plans in place in order to develop these two traits.
- I am moving from being a passenger to becoming the driver.
- I am now fully prepared to begin my career in IT at the Bank of Ceylon.